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## Research Brief II: Economic Report Influence Graph

### Statutory extraction, exhaustive sweeps, and an adversarial round — 2026-07-29

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#### 0. Read this first: what changed since the last brief

Your previous results were checked line by line against the source documents. The outcome is worth stating precisely, because this brief is built around it.

**What you did excellently.** You found things that ordinary searching does not surface. Footnote 4 of the July 2026 *Monetary Policy Report* — “*LFS-Micro is a measure of underlying wage growth derived from the Labour Force Survey (LFS) microdata*” — is buried in a 40-page PDF and settles an edge that had been open for four sessions. You also found “*Sources: US Bureau of Economic Analysis via Haver Analytics and Bank of Canada calculations, estimates and projections*”, which turns out to be **the first standard-compliant direct link between the Canadian and American statistical systems in the entire graph**. Both quotes verified exactly. Three of your finds are now permanent edges.

**Where it went wrong.** You returned `boc-mpr` → `statcan-national-accounts` as DOCUMENTED and offered this as proof: “*Sources: Statistics Canada and Bank of Canada calculations and estimates.*” That is agency-level attribution, which the brief said fails — and which your own reply, two paragraphs earlier, said you were treating as a failure. The document was then searched directly: **the phrase “national accounts” does not occur in the July 2026 MPR even once**. You also noticed that item 1’s quote described reconciliation running the opposite way to the edge, wrote that down, and marked it DOCUMENTED anyway.

**The pattern, stated without blame:** your document-finding and quotation are reliable. Your *adjudication* — deciding whether a quote proves a claim — is not, and it fails in one consistent direction, toward yes.

So this brief changes the division of labour. **For most of what follows you are not asked for a verdict at all.** You are asked to extract and quote. Someone else decides what it proves. This is not a demotion; it is pointing you at the half of the work you are measurably better at, and it should also let you go much faster, because you no longer have to agonise over sufficiency.

Where judgement is genuinely required, this brief forces you to argue the opposite case before you are allowed to conclude.

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## 1. The standing rule, unchanged

**If no document explicitly names the source, the edge does not exist — however obvious the relationship looks.**

The graph's value is that it is auditable rather than plausible. Every quote you return will be checked against the URL you give it. That is not a threat, it is the workflow — and last round it took about five minutes and caught one error before it became permanent.

**The distinction that decides most cases:** naming an *agency* is not naming a *release*. "Sources: Statistics Canada" does not identify which of several hundred Statistics Canada products was used. "derived from the Labour Force Survey (LFS) microdata" does. If you internalise one thing from the last round, make it this one.

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## 2. Output formats

Three formats. Use the one the round specifies. Do not substitute.

### FORMAT E — Extraction (most rounds)

No verdict. No assessment of sufficiency. Just what the document says.

DOC: <title, publisher, version/date>  
URL: <direct link, deep-linked where possible>  
FOUND: <how many matching passages>

[1] QUOTE: "<verbatim, unedited, including surrounding sentence for context>"  
LOCATION: <section / page / footnote / chart or table number>  
NAMES: <every named release, series, survey, index or dataset in the quote, listed. If it names only an agency, write "AGENCY ONLY: <name>".>

[2] ...

If a document contains nothing matching, say so and give the URL you opened. That is a result, not a failure.

### FORMAT S — Statutory extraction (Round A)

INSTRUMENT: <Act or Regulation, full citation>  
URL: <link>  
PROVISION: <section, subsection, paragraph>  
QUOTE: "<verbatim text of the provision>"  
NAMES: <every statistical series, index, survey or dataset named>  
DEFINED-AS: <if the provision defines the term elsewhere, quote that too>

### FORMAT J — Judged (Round D only)

Only here are you asked to conclude, and only with a mandatory counter-case:

TARGET: <the edge>  
CASE FOR: <quotes supporting it>  
CASE AGAINST: <the strongest argument this edge should NOT exist. You must write a real one. "No counter-argument" is not an acceptable answer — if you cannot construct one, say what would have to be true for the

edge to fail, and whether you checked it.>  
CONCLUSION: <which case is stronger, and by how much>

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### 3. ROUND A — Statutory extraction: the Equalization formula

**This is the largest prize in the brief and the round most suited to you.** It is almost pure extraction from primary legislation, with very little judgement.

Equalization currently sits in the graph as a leaf with one edge. The formula is in the **Federal-Provincial Fiscal Arrangements Act (R.S.C. 1985, c. F-8)** and the **Federal-Provincial Fiscal Arrangements Regulations, 2007**. It reportedly defines a **Representative Tax System** with revenue bases for personal income, business income, consumption and property taxes, each tied to a defined data source.

**Task A1.** Work through the Act and Regulations and extract, in FORMAT S, every provision that names a statistical series, survey, index, dataset or publication as an input to any calculation. Include the definitions sections — that is usually where “population”, “revenue base” and similar terms are pinned to specific sources.

**Task A2.** Do the same for the **Canada Health Transfer** and **Canada Social Transfer** escalator provisions in the same Act. The CHT escalator is tied to a GDP measure; find exactly which one the statute names and how it is averaged.

**Task A3.** Same again for **Territorial Formula Financing** and the **Fiscal Stabilization** program, both in the same instrument family.

**What matters most:** the exact wording pinning each base to a source, and the section number. Where the statute names Statistics Canada without a release, record it as AGENCY ONLY — do not resolve it yourself, that is the adjudication step.

Expect this to be long. Length is fine. Completeness is the goal.

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### 4. ROUND B — Exhaustive source-line sweep

**Pure volume extraction. No judgement whatsoever.** This is the round that should take you longest and where your lack of rate limits matters most.

Central bank reports attribute every chart and table. Those attribution strings are the raw material for a dozen edges, and nobody has ever tabulated them.

**Task B1.** Take the **last eight issues of the Bank of Canada Monetary Policy Report** (July 2026 back through roughly October 2024; they are at [bankofcanada.ca/publications/mpr/](https://bankofcanada.ca/publications/mpr/), and the PDFs are easier to work with than the web pages). For **every chart, table and figure**, transcribe the source line verbatim, with the chart/table number and issue date.

Return it as a flat list. Do not summarise, do not deduplicate, do not group. I want to see how often each distinct attribution string occurs, which requires the raw list.

Also capture every **footnote** in those issues that names a data source — footnote 4 of the July 2026 issue is the model, and it is the kind of thing that never appears in a source line.

**Task B2.** The same sweep for the **Federal Reserve’s Monetary Policy Report to Congress**, last four issues.

**Task B3.** The same for the **Summary of Economic Projections** — every issue’s table notes and footnotes for the last four meetings. The SEP defines what each projected variable means, and those definitions are the most likely place to find whether the unemployment projection is pinned to a specific survey.

**Why this is worth your time:** it settles several open edges at once, it will almost certainly surface sources nobody has thought to look for, and it converts a judgement problem into a counting problem.

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## 5. ROUND C — The eleven remaining unproven edges, as extraction

Eleven edges in the graph still have no supporting document. **You are not being asked whether they are true.** For each, you are given a target document and asked to extract every passage mentioning the thing in question, in FORMAT E.

**C1.** In StatCan’s *Guide to the Income and Expenditure Accounts* (13-017-X) and the *User Guide: Canadian System of Macroeconomic Accounts* (13-606-G): extract every passage mentioning **the Consumer Price Index**, and separately every passage mentioning **monthly GDP by industry**. For the second, capture the surrounding sentences on both sides — the direction of the relationship is contested and cannot be judged from a fragment.

**C2.** In Bank of Canada publications on **potential output and the output gap**: extract every passage naming a Statistics Canada release.

**C3.** In the Bank of Canada’s **Summary of Governing Council Deliberations** (last six): extract every passage naming a specific statistical release. These are new documents — first published 2023 — and have never been searched for this.

**C4.** In the Fed’s **Statement on Longer-Run Goals and Monetary Policy Strategy** and the **FOMC projections FAQ**: extract every passage naming a specific release or survey.

**C5.** In the **SEP notes** specifically: extract the full definitional text for the unemployment rate projection and the real GDP growth projection. Verbatim, in full — these are short and precision matters more than volume.

**C6.** The Bank of Canada’s **fixed announcement date** materials and MPR release notes: extract anything stating the relationship between the Report and the rate decision published alongside it.

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## 6. ROUND D — Adversarial: try to break the graph

**The only round where you give verdicts, and the only round where the goal is destruction.** Use FORMAT J, with its mandatory counter-case.

Eight edges are currently in the graph marked implied — meaning: believed on strong grounds, no document states it. They are excluded from scoring but they are still assertions, and if any is simply wrong it should go.

**Your task is to falsify them.** For each, the win condition is finding a document that shows the relationship does not hold, runs to a different release, or runs in the opposite direction. A confirmation is a lesser result here.

1. gp-financial-statements → gp-tax-rate-by-law — City of Grande Prairie
2. cgp-financial-statements → cgp-assessment-roll — County of Grande Prairie
3. cgp-budget → ab-municipalaffairs-lgff-capital — Local Government Fiscal Framework capital allocation
4. gppsd-financial-statements → psab-psas — Grande Prairie Public School Division under PSAB standards
5. ab-child-family-benefit → canada-child-benefit
6. ab-oil-par-prices → nymex-wti-settlement-prices
7. ab-dip-requisition → ab-oilsands-royalty-rates
8. cihi-nhex → canada-health-transfer

**Also attack these four, which are currently marked documented with evidence.** If any of them is weaker than it looks, that is a more valuable finding than anything else in this brief:

9. canada-health-transfer → statcan-population-estimates — check the regulation actually names the *quarterly demographic estimates* and not the census
10. fiscal-equalization-program → statcan-population-estimates — same check
11. bea-pce → bls-cpi — check the NIPA Handbook supports calculated\_from rather than something weaker
12. boc-mpr → bea-gdp — the edge you found. Attack your own result: does “via Haver Analytics” weaken the claim that the MPR uses the BEA release directly?

Item 12 is not a trick. It is a real question about whether an intermediary breaks the chain, and your view is wanted.

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## 7. ROUND E — Missing nodes

Research each well enough to become a node: official title, publisher, stable URL, releases per year, one-line description. Then extract, in FORMAT E, passages supporting any edge to or from it.

**E1. US Treasury daily yield curve / interest rate statistics — highest priority.** The Fed’s H.15 release currently does not exist in the graph, because its only edge was deleted after checking. H.15’s footnotes 9 and 10 both read “*Source: U.S. Treasury*” and describe the yields as “*interpolated by the U.S. Treasury from the daily yield curve.*” The evidence exists; the node does not. Research the Treasury release and H.15 returns.

**E2. Canada Community-Building Fund.** Named in Grande Prairie’s 2026 budget as a \$5,160,000 capital source. Formula-allocated, documented, never researched.

**E3. Public Accounts of Alberta.** CIHI states: “*For the provincial/territorial government sector, data is extracted annually from the public accounts of provincial/territorial governments.*” Edge documented, node absent.

**E4. Finance Canada economic and fiscal projections.** The *Actuarial Report on the Employment Insurance Premium Rate* says at s.4.2.2: “*This assumption is provided by the Minister of Finance.*” Determine whether a specific published document exists behind that phrase, or whether it is an internal transfer with no public release — both answers are useful, and the second closes the question permanently.

**E5. US Basel implementation.** The Fed maintains a Basel Regulatory Framework page; US capital rules are Basel-derived. The Canadian half of this chain is in the graph, the American half is missing.

**E6. Haver Analytics.** Establish whether it publishes anything of its own on a cadence, or is purely a redistributor of other people’s data. This decides whether it can exist in the graph at all.

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## 8. ROUND F — Open-ended: what are we missing?

Unstructured, and genuinely open. You have read more of this corpus than anyone.

**F1. Which statutory indexation formulas** in Canada or the US name a specific statistical series and are *not* in the node list in section 9? The graph already has AISH, CRA indexation, CPP, OAS, Social Security COLA and the US tax code. What else is out there of that shape?

**F2. Where does a statute anticipate a methodological break** in an upstream statistic? The graph contains one striking example: CPP s.18(7) requires the Minister, on the advice of the Chief Statistician, to splice Statistics Canada’s average weekly earnings back onto its former basis if

the definition changes by more than 1%. Legislation anticipating a statistical revision is rare and interesting. Find more.

**F3.** Where else does a **commercial or private data source** sit inside an official calculation? Known cases: J.D. Power supplying every used-car price in the US CPI; ICE Brent and Argus Mexico Maya named in Alberta's bitumen valuation regulation; Haver Analytics as an intermediary in the MPR. There will be others, and they are exactly the cases the graph exists to expose.

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## 9. Existing node identifiers

Attach every proposed edge to an identifier from this list where one exists.

**Canada — federal (39):** boc-bank-rate, boc-corra, boc-daily-exchange-rates, boc-mortgage-qualifying-rate, boc-mpc, boc-policy-rate, boc-posted-chartered-bank-rates, boc-prime-rate, canada-child-benefit, canada-health-transfer, canada-social-transfer, cdic-differential-premiums-manual, cmhc-mortgage-loan-insurance, cmhc-residential-mortgage-industry-report, cpp-disability-amount, cpp-pension-index, cpp-ympe, cra-indexation-adjustment, dof-insured-mortgage-qualifying-rules, ei-actuarial-report-premium-rate, ei-maximum-insurable-earnings, ei-premium-rate, ei-regional-unemployment-rates, ei-regular-benefit-rate, esdc-oas-indexation, fiscal-equalization-program, osfi-b20, osfi-car-guideline, osfi-mqr-uninsured, statcan-census-population, statcan-cpi, statcan-cpi-basket-update, statcan-gdp-monthly, statcan-hfce, statcan-lfs, statcan-national-accounts, statcan-population-estimates, statcan-seph, statcan-shs

**Canada — provincial, Alberta (28):** ab-aadl-cost-share, ab-adult-health-benefit-income-levels, ab-aish-benefit-rates, ab-bvm-components, ab-child-family-benefit, ab-continuing-care-accommodation-charges, ab-dip-requisition, ab-education-funding-manual, ab-education-property-tax-requisition, ab-education-student-enrolment, ab-gas-reference-price, ab-income-support-rates, ab-mrf-guidelines, ab-municipalaffairs-equalized-assessment, ab-municipalaffairs-financial-statistical-data, ab-municipalaffairs-fir, ab-municipalaffairs-lgff-capital, ab-municipalaffairs-population-list, ab-oil-par-prices, ab-oilsands-royalty-rates, ab-regulated-property-guidelines, ab-seniors-benefit-rates, ab-tbf-alberta-escalator, ab-tbf-economic-outlook, ab-tbf-fiscal-plan, ab-tbf-fiscal-update, ab-tbf-population-estimates, aer-general-well-data

**Canada — municipal (10):** cgp-assessment-roll, cgp-budget, cgp-financial-statements, cgp-municipal-census, cgp-tax-rate-by-law, gp-assessment-roll, gp-budget, gp-financial-statements, gp-municipal-census, gp-tax-rate-by-law

**Canada — institutional (8):** ahs-business-plan, ahs-financial-statements, cihi-nhex, gppsd-budget, gppsd-financial-statements, grande-spirit-requisition, psab-psas, term-corra

**United States — federal (22):** bea-gdp, bea-pce, bls-c-cpi-u, bls-cex, bls-cpi, bls-employment-situation, bls-qcew, cps-current-population-survey, fed-fomc-statement, fed-h8, fed-sep, fed-z1, ffiec-call-report, hhs-poverty-guidelines, irs-annual-inflation-adjustments, ssa-cola, ssa-contribution-benefit-base, ssa-national-average-wage-index, ssa-pia-formula, uscensus-decennial, uscensus-population-estimates, uscensus-poverty-thresholds

**International (9):** bis-basel-framework, cpi-manual, icls-work-statistics-resolution, imf-bpm6, imf-gfsm, ipsas, naics, sna-2008, un-census-principles

**Commercial (4):** jd-power-valuation-services, nymex-wti-settlement-prices, ice-brent-futures-settlement, argus-mexico-maya-spot

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## 10. Discipline for this round

Four things, all of them learned from last time.

**One. Do not adjudicate unless the round asks you to.** Rounds A, B, C and E want extraction. If you find yourself writing “this satisfies the standard”, you have switched tasks. Quote it, name what it names, move on. Adjudication happens at the other end and it is not your bottleneck.

**Two. AGENCY ONLY is a first-class answer.** When a source line names an agency and no release, that is exactly what to write. It is not a failed result. Last round the single error came from resolving an AGENCY ONLY into a release.

**Three. Never override your own doubt silently.** Last round you observed that a quote described reconciliation running the opposite direction to the claimed edge, and then concluded DOCUMENTED anyway. If you notice a problem, the noticing is the valuable part — record it prominently and let it stand unresolved. A flagged uncertainty is worth more than a confident answer, because it is actionable and a wrong confident answer is not.

**Four. Report as you go, by round.** Do not hold everything for one complete answer at the end. Partial output arriving early is more useful than a complete answer arriving late, and if you run out of room mid-way, what you have already sent still counts.

**On social media as a source, unchanged from last time:** useful as a finding aid for locating primary documents, never a substitute for one. An announcement is not a methodology. Follow the link, read the document, cite the document.

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## 11. Priority, if you cannot do it all

1. **Round A** — the Equalization statute. Largest single gain available.
2. **Round B1** — the eight-issue MPR source-line sweep. Pure extraction and it feeds several open questions at once.
3. **Round D** — the adversarial round. Highest value per unit effort, because removing a wrong edge is worth more than adding a right one.
4. **Round E1** — the Treasury yield curve, which restores a release that has fallen out of the graph entirely.
5. Everything else.

Volume is welcome. Length is welcome. Raw is welcome. Certainty is not required and, in most of these rounds, not even wanted.